

FIELD NOTES FROM A DEVELOPMENT FINANCE INTERNSHIP

3 Lessons Every Finance Student Should Learn Before Their First Internship

Textbooks teach you what a board resolution is. They don't teach you who drafts it, who signs it, which professional files it, and what happens if it reaches the Registrar three days late. I spent eight weeks as a Development Finance Intern at Access Livelihoods, Hyderabad — a collective of social enterprises — working under the Chief of Operations on director appointments, a corporate name change, DEMAT conversion, shareholder evaluation, a Rs 17.67 lakh bank guarantee renewal, and a gratuity liability model. These are the five things I wish someone had told me before Day One.

1

Learn How Real Meetings Happen — and Map the Hierarchy Before You Arrive

Classroom group projects don't prepare you for how decisions are actually made. A real meeting runs on an agenda, produces **minutes**, and every decision leaves with an **owner and a deadline**.

Equally important: know the reporting structure before you walk in. I reported to the COO, who reported to the board; the Company Secretary and Chartered Accountant sat outside the organisation but plugged into it at specific points. Knowing this map told me whose email carried a decision and whose carried a request. Don't import corporate stiffness; read the culture first.

BEFORE DAY ONE

- ✓ Study the LinkedIn profiles of your reporting officer, their manager, and the leadership team — know names, roles and tenure cold.
- ✓ Sketch the org chart: who reports to whom, and where external professionals (CS, CA, auditors, bankers) plug in.
- ✓ In every meeting, capture decisions as owner + action + deadline; volunteer to write the minutes — it is the fastest way to learn.

2

Know the Legal Documents That Run a Company Day to Day

Within my first two weeks I had handled more legal paper than in two years of coursework: MOA and AOA (the company's constitution — objects, capital, internal rules), board resolutions (the formal instrument behind every corporate action), EGM notices and minutes, DIR-2 consent forms for incoming directors, rental agreements, NOCs, MoUs on e-stamp paper, share certificates, and tripartite agreements with the depository. None of these is exotic — they are the everyday plumbing of any registered company — yet most finance students meet them for the first time on the job.

Learn to read them for structure, not just content: who are the parties, what is being resolved or transferred, who must sign, what gets attached as proof, and where it gets filed. And know the escalation map: corporate-law documents go to the **Company Secretary**, financial statements and tax to the **Chartered Accountant**, contracts to the legal advisor — asking the right professional saves days.

BEFORE DAY ONE

- ✓ Be able to explain in one line each: MOA, AOA, board resolution, EGM/AGM notice, minutes, DIR-2, share certificate, MoU, NOC.
- ✓ Skim one real MoA/AoA (MCA filings of any company work) so the format isn't alien on the job.
- ✓ For any document you're handed, ask three questions: who signs it, what attaches to it, where does it get filed?

3

Understand What CAs and Company Secretaries Actually Do

Half of a finance intern's job is coordination. You can't coordinate people whose roles you don't understand.

The **Company Secretary** is the guardian of corporate procedure: board processes, ROC filings, name reservations (RUN), statutory registers, and the sequencing of resolutions, meetings and forms. The **Chartered Accountant** owns the numbers: audits, financial statements, tax, GST, and certifications like net-worth certificates. Around them sit auditors, bankers, insurers and legal advisors — each with a narrow, deep mandate. During my internship, I coordinated with all of them, and the single biggest unlock was simply knowing which question belongs to whom.

BEFORE DAY ONE

- ✓ Learn the division of labour: CS = corporate procedure and ROC; CA = accounts, audit and tax; auditor = independent verification; banker = instruments and accounts.
- ✓ Never send a professional a partial document set — incomplete packets are the #1 cause of delay.
- ✓ Confirm calls in writing the same day; professionals work across many clients and written trails prevent rework.